SOC-06 | Therapist only - all age groups

Using skills across relationships

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Summarize useful communication skills and choose how to adapt them to different relationships and contexts. Also plan a response to rejection or change, with support and choice that do not depend on controlling others.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

No single communication style suits every relationship. Renewing contact, persuading someone whose wishes changed, or adapting to harm are not required. Significant distress or an unsafe situation requires support beyond this sheet.

Reusing existing material

SOC-01 to SOC-05 offer boundaries, clarification, requests, disagreement and initiative. Here existing tools are chosen and adapted to context; repeating or using every sheet is unnecessary.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Gil learned to ask a friend for clarification. Before a conversation in a volunteering setting, he adapts the wording and timing and keeps the option of seeking advice if his request is not answered.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What tool will I choose to use in another context?

2 | Question for discussion

What relationship differences require changes in wording or channel?

3 | Question for discussion

What need or boundary remains the same for me?

4 | Question for discussion

What can I do about rejection outside my control?

5 | Question for discussion

What will signal a need for support or another approach?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

A tool that helped in one relationship may not fit another. Do not attribute this to personal failure. If rejection causes strong distress, allow support instead of immediate further practice.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose another familiar, safe relationship without turning every meeting into practice. A supporting adult allows disappointment and helps after refusal without pressuring the other child.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Distinguish contact with a friend from contact with an authority figure. Personal wording, privacy and a communication style different from others may be preserved.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Include changes in role, setting or availability. Adapting does not mean giving up rights or boundaries; support can come from outside the relationship being explored.

OA | Older adults

Allow wishes to maintain, change or end a relationship. Do not assume every change is age-related or make renewed contact compulsory.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose one safe context or fictional example and plan support for disappointment. Contacting someone again after refusal or returning to an unwanted relationship is not required.

At the next session

Explore what remained useful in the skill and what needed adapting to context. Completing the series summarizes choices and possible tools, not an expectation to manage every relationship alone.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Assertiveness

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